

CUSTOMER SUCCESS CASE STUDY

HOW A FRACTIONAL CMO PRACTICE BUILT EIGHT ACQUISITION ENGINES FROM THE GROUND UP

COMBINING PAID MEDIA, SEO, CRO, LIFECYCLE AUTOMATION AND ATTRIBUTION ACROSS A PORTFOLIO OF CONSULTING ENGAGEMENTS

Organisation	Portfolio of eight consulting clients
Period	May 2018 - May 2021
Role / scope	Strategic Marketing Consultant and Growth Advisor Fractional CMO engagements
Audience	CMOs, marketing leaders, CEOs and hiring managers

EXECUTIVE OUTCOME

Across eight consulting engagements, the work built acquisition engines from scratch by integrating paid media infrastructure, conversion-funnel optimisation, lifecycle automation and attribution frameworks. Documented portfolio outcomes included \$2.2M in incremental revenue, 27% aggregate growth in qualified lead volume, an average 33% increase in organic visibility, 2.4x ROAS through programmatic display and 12 website redesign or optimisation projects with an average 18% conversion-rate improvement. These are aggregate portfolio outcomes and should be presented with scope clearly stated.

METRIC REGISTER AND PUBLICATION STATUS

Each metric is either documented in the supplied profile/project material or marked as an illustrative validation item. Validation items are prompts for recovering the original baseline, denominator, source and attribution; they are not public claims.

Metric	Value	Definition	Status / publication note
Incremental revenue	\$2.2M	Aggregate incremental revenue across eight consulting engagements.	Documented portfolio outcome; confirm attribution.
Qualified lead volume	+27% aggregate	Aggregate increase in qualified lead volume across clients.	Documented portfolio outcome.
Organic visibility	+33% average	Average increase in organic visibility across clients.	Documented portfolio outcome; define visibility.
Programmatic ROAS	2.4x	Return on advertising spend for programmatic display activity.	Documented outcome; confirm numerator.
Website projects	12	Website redesign and optimisation projects led.	Documented project count.
Conversion rate	+18% average	Average conversion-rate improvement	Documented portfolio outcome;

across website projects.

confirm denominator.

BUSINESS CONTEXT AND CUSTOMER CHALLENGE

A fractional CMO often enters when a business knows growth is important but lacks a complete acquisition system. The client may have a website but no conversion path, campaigns but no attribution, content but no distribution, or leads but no nurture.

The challenge across the portfolio was to diagnose quickly, prioritise carefully and build practical systems that small or growing teams could operate. Resources were limited, but the fundamentals still mattered: audience, proposition, channel mix, conversion, lifecycle, reporting and sales alignment.

STRATEGIC DIAGNOSIS

Growth constraints were interconnected. A client might ask for more leads when the real problem was qualification, or ask for SEO when the website did not convert existing traffic.

The portfolio model applied a repeatable framework while adapting to each client's market, maturity, team and economics. That combination of structure and flexibility is the value of fractional leadership.

CAMPAIGN SUCCESS MATRIX

The matrix makes the operating logic visible: business need, strategic move, execution system and success signal. It is deliberately designed for executive readers who want to understand how the work created a repeatable capability, not only a headline result.

Business need	Strategic move	Execution system	Success signal
Diagnose	find the binding growth constraint	Funnel, channel, journey and attribution review	Prioritised growth backlog
Acquire	create qualified demand	Paid media, SEO, content and syndication	Qualified lead volume +27% aggregate
Convert	improve the value of existing traffic	CRO, testing, heat maps and automation	Average conversion-rate improvement
Prove	connect work to commercial impact	Attribution, reporting and client QBRs	\$2.2M aggregate incremental revenue

APPROACH AND EXECUTION

1. 1. BEGIN WITH THE BUSINESS MODEL

The first move was find the binding growth constraint. Each engagement clarified how the client made money, who the buyer was and where the commercial process slowed. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit,

choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

The second part was operational discipline. Each engagement clarified how the client made money, who the buyer was and where the commercial process slowed. The work was reviewed through the lens of diagnose, so decisions could be made with context rather than by chasing an isolated channel metric. This helped preserve the customer experience while improving the organisation's ability to execute, learn and adapt.

This move also created a reusable lesson. Prioritised growth backlog The result should be interpreted as evidence of the system working, not as proof that one tactic alone created every business outcome. That distinction makes the story more credible for senior readers and gives future teams a clearer way to reproduce the useful part of the work.

2. 2. BUILD THE ACQUISITION FOUNDATION

The first move was create qualified demand. The right foundation was built before spend scaled, with every channel assigned a job in the journey. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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3. 3. IMPROVE CONVERSION AND LIFECYCLE

The first move was improve the value of existing traffic. Website and lifecycle work improved the path from attention to action and reduced the risk of captured demand disappearing. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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4. 4. MAKE PERFORMANCE VISIBLE

The first move was connect work to commercial impact. Client-facing reporting translated activity into decisions about what to scale, fix or stop. Nikhil's role was to connect the commercial objective with the practical work required to deliver it. That meant making the problem explicit, choosing a workable intervention and ensuring that the team could see what would happen next. In a complex marketing environment, this clarity is valuable because it prevents activity from becoming disconnected from the outcome.

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MEASUREMENT, ATTRIBUTION AND OPERATING DISCIPLINE

Portfolio metrics need explicit scope. \$2.2M is aggregate across eight engagements; lead and visibility growth are portfolio averages; 2.4x needs a value numerator; 18% needs a conversion denominator. The supplied material documents these outcomes, but final publication should retain confirmed definitions.

A senior reader should be able to tell which evidence proves execution, which evidence proves engagement and which evidence proves commercial impact. The case therefore keeps metric definitions close to the story. Where the supplied material documents a practice-level or portfolio-level result, the narrative says so. Where a project-specific number is unavailable, the document names the recovery task instead of manufacturing precision.

BUSINESS IMPACT AND CUSTOMER-SUCCESS INTERPRETATION

Clients gained more than isolated campaigns. They gained acquisition engines that could keep producing learning and demand after the initial intervention. Founders and leadership teams also gained a clearer way to discuss marketing in commercial terms.

For hiring managers, this demonstrates breadth with operating depth: enter different businesses, find the real constraint, design a cross-channel response, work with teams and communicate results executives can use.

WHAT THIS CASE DEMONSTRATES TO AN EXECUTIVE READER

- Fractional leadership begins with diagnosis, not a predetermined channel solution.
- A growth engine must be sized to the client's operating capacity.
- CRO, lifecycle and attribution can matter as much as acquisition media.
- Aggregate metrics are persuasive only when scope is stated.

End of case study